

MARKETING PLAN · MAY 2026

Wild Mongolia with Tugi

How to fill 10 tours with 86 followers and zero ad budget.

Prepared for: Tugi

Status: Living document — edit it, kill what doesn't work.

The position.

“Not a tour company. Just me, Tugi, taking 5–8 people across Mongolia at a price that doesn't punish you for being curious.”

The competitor scan (Stone Horse, Eternal Landscapes, Sunpath, Nomadic Trails) shows nobody currently owns the combination of:

- **Personal** — Tugi's face on everything.
- **Accessible price** — published, \$350–\$1,300, not hidden behind a quote form.
- **Small group** — 5–8, never bigger.
- **Camping-not-luxury** — gers and tents, not eco-resorts.

Lean into the underdog truth.

86 followers, 1 of 10 tours already sold out by word of mouth, no marketing budget. **That IS the story.** Don't pretend to be bigger.

CHAPTER TWO

This week — the only list that matters.

Five actions. In order. Everything else waits.

1. **Set up 6 Instagram Highlights** — Tours 2026 / What to expect / Hosts & gers / On the road / Reviews / FAQ. New profile visitors see this before anything else. *2 hours.*
2. **Submit INDY Guide listing** at indyguide.com/mongolia. Free, evergreen, pre-qualified traveler intent. *30 min.*
3. **Polish & host the “Mongolia in Summer” PDF guide** (already drafted at public/downloads/mongolia-summer-guide.pdf). Wire MailerLite free tier. Add sign-up form on home + every tour page. *1 day.*
4. **Walk into 3 UB hostels with cards** — Sunpath, Danista, Khongor. 10% commission on overflow referrals. In person, in Mongolian. *1 afternoon.*
5. **Shortlist 15 micro-creators** (20–80k IG, Mongolia-curious, >3% engagement). Send one batch DM pitch. Expect 1–2 yeses. *3 hours.*

CHAPTER THREE

Weekly content rhythm (after week 1).

Cadence

4 Reels + 1 carousel + daily Stories per week. Every Reel → TikTok 24h later (CapCut, no extra filming). Skip Threads.

Reel hook archetypes that win for adventure travel

1. **POV sensory open** — *“POV: you wake up in a ger and the only sound is a horse breathing outside your door.”*
2. **Pattern interrupt** — *“Stop scrolling if you're booking Asia in 2026.”*
3. **Quiet flex** — Bali clip → cut to Khövsgöl. *“While everyone's in Bali...”*
4. **Founder-to-camera** — Tugi's face, no edit, dry voice. **Unfair advantage; overuse it.**
5. **Numbered list carousels** — *“5 things I don't do on my tours.”* Save magnet.

Monthly post-type mix

- **12 proof posts** — past-trip footage.
- **8 education** — packing, ger etiquette, weather, money, Naadam explained.
- **6 founder-voice** — Tugi to camera.
- **4 direct CTAs** — booking, link in bio, sold-out scarcity.

Hashtags — first comment, never the caption

#mongolia · #visitmongolia · #mongoliatravel · #mongoliaadventure · #gobi · #khuvsgul · #nomadlife · #gertrip · #centralasia · #offthebeatenpath · #slowtravel · #smallgrouptours · #adventuretravel · #responsibletravel · #solotravel · #wildmongoliatugi

Avoid: #travel · #explore · #wanderlust · #love. Banned-adjacent / oversaturated.

CHAPTER FOUR

Distribution channels — 3 only.

Two platforms done well beats six platforms half-done.

Channel	Cadence	Format that works	Don't
Reddit (r/Mongolia, r/solotravel, r/backpacking, r/onebag)	3–4 substantive comments/week + 1 trip-report post/month	Helpful answers signed first name; AMA if a breaking story in pitch	Disrespecting the 90/10 rule is
Facebook groups (Backpackers in MONGOLIA, Mongolia Travel Hub, Solo/Group Backpackers)	5 helpful answers before posting my Tugui local self-entourage group	Grouping links across group	Disrespecting the 90/10 rule is
Naver Cafe ■■■■ (Korean)	1 translated trip report — find Mongolians speaking fluent in Korea (Super for Koreans to be handy.)		

Funnel + tracking.

Bio link points at /tours, not /

One less click for someone already interested.

Track only these 3 events

- tour_view
- book_click — apply button
- book_submit — Formspree

Anything more is noise at this scale.

UTM template on every link Tugi posts manually

```
?utm_source=instagram&utm_medium=bio&utm_campaign=gobi8
```

One Google Sheet, one row per post.

Email follow-up for /book applicants who haven't paid

When	Message
T+0 (within 2 hours)	Personal reply. Tour confirmed, deposit instructions, one paragraph of what happens next. Not a template.
T+48h	Soft nudge: “still holding your spot, here’s a photo from last year’s group at [exact location].”
T+5 days	Honest urgency: “N spots left, M people asking — if not the right time, let me know so I can release the hold.”
T+10 days	Last call: “Releasing your spot tomorrow unless I hear back.” Don’t bluff — actually release.
T+30 days (lost)	“Want me to email you when next year’s dates open?” Moves them to newsletter.

Paid acquisition — \$300 total.

Honest answer

Below \$600 over 30 days, Meta's algorithm can't optimize. **\$300 is better spent on a micro-creator collab.**

Plan A (recommended) — \$300 to creators + boost

- **\$150** → one Mongolia-traveled creator (20–80k IG, >3% engagement). Gifted seat on cheapest tour (\$350) in exchange for 1 Reel + 1 in-feed + 3 Stories + repost rights.
- **\$150** → boost whichever organic Reel hits >5% engagement in week 2 or 3.

Plan B (only if A fails) — pure paid Meta

- Platform: Meta, **Instagram Reels placement only.**
- Objective: **Profile Visits** (not link clicks). At 86 followers, the bottleneck is social proof, not website traffic.
- Targeting: *adventure travel* + *Intrepid* + *Atlas Obscura* + *Much Better Adventures* + *Lonely Planet*, ages 28–45, English-speaking countries (US, UK, AU, DE, NL).
- German + Dutch over-index on Mongolia.
- Creative: 3 organic Reels that already outperformed, \$25 boost each = \$75. Other \$225 = two campaigns at \$8/day × 14 days.

Top 5 partnerships to chase.

1. **One micro-creator (20–80k IG).** Pitch (avoid the word “collaboration”):

“I'm a Mongolian guide running 10 small-group trips this summer. I have one spot reserved for a creator I'd actually want on the trip – interested?”

1. **INDY Guide listing** — free distribution, pre-qualified intent. indyguide.com/mongolia
2. **2–3 UB hostels** — Sunpath / Danista / Khongor. 10% referral commission on overflow bookings. In-person ask in Mongolian beats email 10×.
3. **Korean travel community** — Naver Cafe ■■■■ groups. One Korean-translated trip report significantly outperforms English-only reach.
4. **University outdoor clubs** — ANU, TU Munich, Utrecht. Email club presidents offering 10% group discount for 4+ bookings. One yes = a half-full tour.

CHAPTER EIGHT

What NOT to do.

- × Drone-only montages with text overlays — algorithm reads as stock.
- × Hashtags in the caption — first comment only.
- × Booking links in Reddit/FB groups before contributing helpful comments.
- × Hide pricing behind a quote form — visible price is a differentiator.
- × Threads / Pinterest / Google Ads as priorities until 1k IG followers.
- × Pretend to be a bigger operator than you are — the underdog truth IS the marketing.
- × Buy followers. Ever.

CHAPTER NINE

KPIs — one spreadsheet, updated weekly.

Metric	Now	Week 6	Week 12
Instagram followers	86	350	800
Avg Reel reach	~500	5,000	12,000
Email list	0	100	300
/book submissions	0–1	15–20	40
Tours filled	1 / 10	4–5 / 10	7–8 / 10

If a metric isn't moving after 4 weeks of consistent effort, change the input. Not the metric.

CHAPTER TEN

Quick-reference snippets.

Reddit reply template

"Local Mongolian guide here. Quick answer: [genuine helpful answer in 2-3 sentences]. If you want the longer version DM me, otherwise this is what I'd do. – Tugi"

Facebook group self intro (one per group max)

"Hi everyone – I'm Tugi, born and raised here, running small-group trips this summer after years of guiding informally. Posting in case any of you are planning Mongolia in June-August. Happy to answer Mongolia questions in the comments either way. Insta: @mongoladventure."

"Sold out scarcity" line for IG captions

"1 of 10 tours already sold out for 2026. Link in bio for the rest."

Micro-creator cold DM

"I'm a Mongolian guide running 10 small-group trips this summer. I have one spot reserved on the cheapest tour (\$350) for a creator I'd actually want on the trip – interested?"

Why this works.

- **Tugi himself is the product.** Everything that surfaces his face, voice, and decisions converts better than landscape footage.
- **Scarcity is real, not manufactured.** 1/10 already sold out, max 8 per group. Mention it without making it the whole message.
- **Solo means narrow.** Two platforms, one lead magnet, one partnership type — done well — beats six things half-done.
- **The website does the work the IG can't.** Each Reel only needs to drive interest; the website carries the conversion.
- **6 months is enough.** International adventure decisions are made 3–6 months out. Tugi is right in the planning window.

This is a living document. Open it, edit it, commit it. Kill what doesn't work. The plan you start with is never the plan you finish with — but starting with a plan is how you find out.